

CJ Rivas

Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect

Experienced Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect with nearly 20 years in the field, specializing in React and AI technologies. Committed to helping your company innovate through AI-driven development. Led initiatives that enhanced user engagement.

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TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI Tooling/LLM

Claude/Codex/Cursor

TypeScript

JavaScript

React

Next.js

Vue.js

Node.js

Design Systems

Emotion/Styled Components

SCSS/CSS

Redux/Zustand

Vite/Webpack/Rollup

Storybook

Jest/Vitest

Playwright

Bun/NPM/Yarn

Git

CI/CD

Responsive Design

E2E Testing

REST API

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Engineer

The Globe and Mail

09/2024 - 05/2026

Delivered AI-enhanced frontend development

- Development of interactive components for The Globe and Mail using React and AI tools, boosting user engagement.
- Streamlined code reviews with AI tools, enhancing code quality and reducing review time.
- Integrated React components with a proprietary CMS, ensuring efficient content management.
- Optimized front-end code through unit testing and refactoring, improving maintainability.
- Used a design system for React components using Storybook, enhancing team collaboration.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to deliver high-quality features on time.

Fullstack Engineer

iPolitics

11/2023 - Present

Achievements/Tasks

- Sole full-stack developer for two news websites (iPolitics, QP Briefing) built with Next.js, React, Prisma, and Sanity CMS; managed server-side development, CI/CD pipelines, and site infrastructure.
- Implemented sponsored articles, podcast section, and authorized admin routes with data analytics to boost user engagement and -management efficiency.
- Debugged and resolved Sanity.io CMS issues while maintaining all backend services and features as a team of one.

Principal Robot

Robots and Pencils

06/2024 - 09/2024

Led frontend development for the ASU student project

- Enhanced ASU project performance by implementing new features, ensuring timely delivery.
- Conducted pull request reviews, maintaining high code quality and best practices.
- Identified and implemented UI/UX solutions for improved interface performance.
- Refined features based on user testing feedback, boosting app performance.
- Managed the ASU project lifecycle, demonstrating strong technical and project management skills.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Engineer

XP Ventures Labs

03/2024 - 05/2024

Converted legacy react app into micro-frontends

- Led conversion of legacy React JavaScript application to TypeScript micro-frontends, modernizing architecture and improving.
- Migrated global state from Redux to Zustand and refactored components to modern React patterns, enhancing performance and reducing complexity.
- Designed and implemented CI/CD pipeline with automated linting, formatting, unit, and E2E tests, accelerating development cycles.
- Championed TypeScript and React best practices through code reviews and updated team standards, elevating code quality.
- Architected modular micro-frontend structure enabling independent deployments and team collaboration.
- Reduced technical debt and optimized frontend tooling for improved developer experience and long-term maintainability.

Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect

Radian

06/2022 - 11/2023

Front-end lead developer and architect for homegeniusrealestate.com project (React Typescript)

- Served as Front-End Lead Architect for homegeniusrealestate.com (React/TypeScript).
- Architected and led full frontend development from scratch to production using Next.js, TypeScript, GraphQL, and Nest.js.
- Delivered complete real estate platform to market in under one year.
- Designed scalable React design system with Storybook for component-driven development.
- Managed NX monorepo with Docker; enforced standards through code reviews and mentoring.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams on advanced search, interactive maps, and user dashboards.
- Optimized performance via code splitting, lazy loading, and GraphQL, achieving superior Core Web Vitals.
- Reduced technical debt and established frontend best practices for faster development and long-term maintainability.

Senior Frontend Engineer + Architect

Varicent

01/2021 - 06/2022

Front-end Architect for various projects within Varicent (React Typescript)

- As Frontend Architect collaborating directly with the CTO, migrated React JavaScript components to TypeScript across projects, boosting performance and maintainability.
- Overhauled webpack configuration and migrated to Vite + esbuild for significantly faster builds.
- Conducted performance testing and implemented key frontend optimizations.
- Implemented NX monorepo with custom bash scripts, enhancing development workflow.
- Optimized GitHub workflows via parallelization and smart caching.
- Prototyped experimental modules and components as Frontend Architect.

Lead Frontend Engineer

RBC Ventures

08/2019 - 08/2020

Front-end specialist on flagship RBC Ventures project (React)

- Strategized and developed new front-end features for the admin app, enabling efficient management of all users
- Migrated the app from the built-in React framework to a custom framework utilizing React Hooks
- Optimized UI experience and performance by implementing webpack chunks, lazy loading, and caching data in memory
- Mentored new team members and shared knowledge while demoing new features to stakeholders
- Updated and maintained the CI workflow and created custom bash scripts to streamline the development process

WORK EXPERIENCE

Frontend Team Lead

Toronto Star

12/2018 - 08/2019

Implemented React website for thestar.com and other local news websites (React)

- Maintained and updated thestar.com using React
- Led the development of a new responsive main menu for thestar.com
- Acted as lead developer, responsible for pull request code review and merging
- Introduced several solutions, including E2E testing, integrated with Jenkins, and Sentry.io to monitor errors in real-time
- Identified workflow issues and proposed possible solutions to optimize processes
- Maintained a high-quality code standard to ensure website performance and user experience
- Conducted interviews with several candidates for front-end developer positions to build a strong team
- Worked in an agile environment, focusing on continuous delivery to meet project deadlines and ensure customer satisfaction

Senior Frontend Engineer

The Globe and Mail

05/2016 - 04/2018

Awarded multiple times for excellent performance by peers

- Developed and maintained website features using vanilla javascript
- Collaborated with the front-end team to build highly performant and responsive components
- Implemented accessibility semantic markup and advanced analytics to enhance user experience
- Participated in code review workflow to ensure high code quality and standards
- Increased unit test code coverage to ensure code stability and reduce bugs
- Consulted and documented UI best practices and code standards to improve development processes
- Delivered a presentation on git workflow to internal team, resulting in increased team efficiency

Frontend Team Lead

Rogers

11/2014 - 01/2016

Awarded service of excellence for front end development by mobileLIVE (AngularJS)

- Developed a Rogers-related application/website and established AngularJS coding conventions for all developers to follow
- Conducted technical interviews with candidates to assess their skills and expertise in AngularJS, ensuring that only the best candidates were selected for the team
- Designed an AngularJS module framework that facilitated collaboration among multiple teams and was adopted by several developers
- Conducted unit testing of front-end code and expanded Bootstrap's AngularUI directives
- Conducted interviews to fill developer positions
- Actively supported and documented front-end solutions, ensuring that all code was thoroughly tested
- Built custom node/gulp modules and provided mentorship to junior developers
- Mentored and engaged in code-pairing with developers to enhance their skills

Intermediate Frontend Developer

Uptime Software

04/2014 - 11/2014

Tasked with becoming the front-end expert for the Uptime Software product (AngularJS)

- Solely responsible for the entire front-end portion of a computer/server monitoring application in a company-wide capacity as the only front-end specialist
- Developed the application using the AngularJS framework
- Implemented a Test-Driven Development (TDD) framework using Jasmine, Karma, and Protractor
- Contributed to the development of shell scripts for continuous integration in Bamboo
- Consumed a proprietary RESTful API layer to build out the graphical user interface (GUI)
- Carried out all front-end duties, including building Gulp tasks



HONOUR AWARDS

Service Excellence - FE (2015)
mobileLIVE

Above and Beyond (2017)
The Globe and Mail

LANGUAGES

English
Native or Bilingual Proficiency

Spanish
Native or Bilingual Proficiency

EDUCATION

Digital Media Arts
Seneca College of Applied Arts and Technology